SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

ASSESSING THE EFFECTIVENESS OF PNP-NASIPIT-PARTNERED BY DRUG SYMPOSIUM SEMINARS ON AWARENESS AND BEHAVIORAL CHANGE

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the study

The Philippines still has much trouble with the fight against illegal drugs. There is an effect on many neighborhoods' safety, health, and peace. The Philippine National Police (PNP) holds drug awareness talks and seminars to help solve this. These activities teach people, especially kids and families, how dangerous drugs are. They encourage everyone to make good choices, stay drug-free, and help their community fight drugs.

It is essential to find out if these drug symposiums led by the PNP are working because they help us know if the programs are really helping people learn about the dangers of drugs and encouraging them to change their behavior for the better. The (Dangerous Drug Board, 2021) says that preventive education is critical because it teaches people the values and information they need to stay away from drugs. That is why community-based programs are an essential part of the country's fight against illegal drugs.

The United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime (UNODC) and the World Health Organization (WHO) believe that awareness campaigns and symposiums can quickly teach people about the risks of drug use and help them develop positive attitudes toward prevention (UNODC, 2018). The updated Drug Abuse Resistance Education (D.A.R.E.) program in the United States, which now includes the keep it real curriculum, has had sound effects, like students getting better at resisting drugs and wanting to use drugs less in the short term (Hansen et al., 2023)

In Europe, the Unplugged program has also worked in the short term by making teens less likely to use drugs and better at saying no (Faggiano et al., 2015) These findings show that short-term interventions, such as symposia and seminars, can significantly enhance awareness and

promote positive behavioral change, particularly when interactive and grounded in established methods.

Drug prevention is a significant priority in the Philippines. The Dangerous Drugs Board (DDB) and the Philippine National Police (PNP) work together to give educational programs and awareness campaigns in communities. The DDB says that teaching people early, primarily through seminars, school activities, and community talks, is an effective way to instill good values and help young people say no to drugs (Dangerous Drug Board, 2021)

Furthermore, the Department of Education (DepEd), the PNP, and the DDB have made drug prevention programs a regular part of school activities. These include symposiums and peer education, where students learn from teachers and fellow students. Studies show that these programs significantly improve students' knowledge and attitudes about illegal drugs (Soriano, 2025) These local efforts show that, just as in other countries, short, simple programs such as symposia and seminars are highly effective in raising awareness and driving rapid, positive behavioral change in Philippine communities.

In addition to the gaps already mentioned, recent studies in the Philippines show that while many drug education, advocacy, and drug-free programs are being actively implemented, there is still very little strict evaluation of whether these programs truly lead to real behavior change. For example, (Pengpid et al., 2025a) found that drug education was linked to lower drug use among school-aged students in the Philippines. However, the study only showed a connection, not proof that seminars or symposiums directly caused the behavior change.

Similarly, in Region XII, programs such as the National Drug Education Program (NDEP) and Barkada Kontra Droga (BKD) were implemented in schools, with strong participation from both teachers and parents. However, the study did not clearly evaluate whether these programs actually led to behavior change among students.

Another study titled A Phenomenological Study of Drug Symposiums in Ternate West National High School found that students became more aware and developed stronger personal convictions after attending the symposiums. However, because the study employed a qualitative approach, its results cannot be generalized to a larger population and did not measure long-term behavioral change. These gaps highlight the need for more empirical research preferably mixed-methods or long-term studies to assess awareness and actual behavioral change resulting from PNP-led drug symposiums.

This study is critical because it provides valuable insights into the effectiveness of PNP-partnered drug symposiums in raising awareness and promoting positive behavior among participants. The results can help the Philippine National Police, the Dangerous Drugs Board (DDB), and the Department of Education (DepEd) assess and improve their preventive education programs. International research shows that prevention efforts are most effective when they combine awareness, life skills, and community participation (UNODC, 2018) Therefore, studying the Philippine experience is essential to determine if these international standards are successfully applied locally.

For policymakers, this study supports the strengthening of the Philippine Anti-Illegal Drugs Strategy (PADS), which emphasizes preventive education as a key tool in addressing the nation's drug problem (Dangerous Drug Board, 2021) For the academic community, it contributes to the limited literature on police-led symposiums in the Philippines by providing evidence of their impact on awareness and behavior. Most importantly, for students and communities, the study highlights how drug education initiatives can empower individuals to make informed decisions and resist the influence of illegal drugs, thereby promoting a safer and drug-free society.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

Drug prevention remains a pressing issue in the Philippines, where education campaigns such as the Philippine National Police (PNP) drug symposium seminars are intended to promote awareness and encourage behavior community responses to change. This study draws on contemporary theories of health. Behavior and communication that explain how educational interventions influence awareness and action.

Theory of Planned Behavior

These factors collectively strengthen an individual's intention to resist drug use. Drug abuse among adolescents poses serious risks to their health and overall well-being. According to a study by (Saeid et al., 2017), the Theory of Planned Behavior is a practical framework for predicting adolescent drug-related behaviors. Drug prevention remains a pressing concern in the Philippines, where education campaigns such as the Philippine National Police (PNP) drug symposiums aim to raise awareness and encourage community-driven behavioral change. This study is grounded in contemporary health behavior and communication theories that explain how educational interventions influence awareness and action.

One such theory is the Theory of Planned Behavior (Ajzen, 2020), which posits that attitudes, subjective norms, and perceived behavioral control shape a person's intentions, and these intentions, in turn, predict actual behavior. In this context, PNP drug symposiums may improve participants' attitudes toward staying drug-free, reinforce anti-drug social norms through community influence, and enhance perceived behavioral control by teaching refusal and decision-making skills.

Furthermore, (Saleem & Rizvi, 2023)) highlight that substance use disorders are a significant global public health concern, causing considerable suffering, trauma, and financial burden. With the increasing prevalence of drug use and its harmful consequences, it is crucial to

identify key predictors and implement adequate preventive measures. Their study specifically examined the utility of the Theory of Planned Behavior (TPB) in predicting students' intentions to use illicit drugs in the Indian context.

Transtheoretical Model

According to Krebs et al., (2018), the Transtheoretical Model (TTM) explains that behavior change is a gradual process that moves through five main stages. The first stage, precontemplation, occurs when a person does not yet recognize that their behavior is a problem or has no intention of changing. The second stage, contemplation, begins when the individual starts to realize that their behavior might be harmful and begins thinking about change. The third stage, preparation, involves making small steps or plans to take action soon. In the action stage, the person actively works to change their behavior, such as reducing or quitting drug use. Finally, in the maintenance stage, they continue practicing their new, healthier habits and work to avoid relapse. Within this framework, PNP drug symposiums can help move individuals from the denial stage (precontemplation) to contemplation and preparation by raising awareness and encouraging reflection. These programs can also support participants who are already in the action or maintenance stages by reinforcing positive behaviors and helping them stay committed to a drug-free lifestyle.

Moreover, (Evers et al., 2015) , note that early use of alcohol, tobacco, and other drugs poses serious risks to students' physical and mental well-being. Continued use can negatively affect multiple areas of their development. In their study, the researchers provided an internet-based, tailored intervention grounded in the Transtheoretical Model of Behavior Change to middle school students to reduce substance use. This digital approach required minimal faculty and staff involvement, making it efficient and practical within the demands of the school curriculum.

Additionally, (Chang et al., 2018), in their study "Evaluation of the effects of a designated program on illegal drug cessation among adolescents", published in Substance Abuse Treatment, Prevention, and Policy, implemented an intervention for adolescents experimenting with illegal drugs and found that early intervention can support drug cessation. Although the study did not explicitly reference the Transtheoretical Model (TTM), its design, which tracks behavioral change over time and assesses readiness for cessation, implicitly reflects stage-based principles of behavioral change. It further supports the idea that programs targeting early-stage drug users can benefit from models like TTM to monitor awareness, readiness, and progress in behavior change.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

The Community-Based Rehabilitation and Wellness Program (CBRP) in Northern Philippines demonstrated the effectiveness of structured, police-led educational interventions in increasing drug awareness and promoting behavioral change among drug surrenderees. In municipalities such as Bagabag, Nueva Vizcaya, and Lingayen, Pangasinan, the Philippine National Police played a key role in facilitating lectures, which participants rated as highly effective — particularly in Bagabag, where the implementation was evaluated as excellent. As part of a broader rehabilitation framework, these lectures significantly enhanced participants' understanding of the dangers of drug use, as well as the legal and health consequences associated with substance abuse.

Unlike other program components, such as recreational activities led by non-police agencies, PNP-led sessions had a more substantial impact on participants, likely due to the credibility and authority of law enforcement officers. The overall structure of the CBRP included psychoeducational sessions, wellness activities, and family involvement, highlighting the importance of a holistic, community-based approach. Integrating police-led education into this support system enabled deeper engagement and reinforced behavioral change. These findings

support the view that community-based symposia and seminars organized by credible institutions such as the PNP can promote greater awareness and sustainable behavioral change (Samuel Buyagawan Damayon, 2025).

According to Hechanova et al. (2018), culturally adapted, community-based drug prevention and rehabilitation programs are more effective than generic approaches. In their Philippine study, they developed an intervention explicitly designed for Filipino drug users, using the Map of Adaptation Process framework. The program incorporated Filipino cultural values, including collectivism, spirituality, and indirect communication. It included evidence-based components such as motivational enhancement, cognitive-behavioral strategies, mindfulness, and life skills training. Culturally relevant tools such as storytelling, prayer, small-group sessions, and art-based activities were used to promote behavior change and support recovery. The involvement of local stakeholders ensured the program's contextual relevance and sustainability. A key finding showed that the experimental group developed a more positive attitude toward the effectiveness of school-community drug prevention strategies.

Additionally, teachers in the experimental group reported that the program strengthened the school's relationship with the community, increased parental involvement, and enhanced their understanding of teachers' critical role in preventing student drug abuse. As a preliminary exploration, the study also discussed its limitations, directions for future research, and how the findings relate to the broader concept of internationalization (Amesty & Páez, 2018).

AGE

Age refers to the length of time a person has lived, usually measured in years, and it often influences their physical, mental, and social development (Cambridge Dictionary, 2023). In the context of drug-related seminars, age plays an important role in shaping a person's awareness, attitudes, and behaviors toward drug use. Younger individuals, particularly adolescents and

students, are more susceptible to peer pressure and curiosity, making them a primary target for preventive education. Older participants, on the other hand, may focus more on community involvement, parenting responsibilities, or rehabilitation.

Therefore, considering age differences during drug symposiums is essential to ensure that the information, strategies, and discussions are suitable and adequate for each age group (UNODC, 2018). Age and sex also play important roles in how individuals are exposed to and respond to drugs.

According to Tannenbaum & Day (2017) highlight the importance of integrating these factors when developing and improving drug prevention and intervention strategies standards. According to (Koechl et al., 2015), drug addiction often begins at a young age, with higher rates seen among adolescents and young adults. However, addiction linked to prescription drugs has become more common among adults and older people. The age at which someone first uses a substance often affects the type of drug they are likely to use, with early use being strongly associated with illicit drug consumption.

GENDER

Gender refers to the socially constructed roles, behaviors, expressions, and identities associated with being male, female, or non-binary. It shapes how individuals see themselves and how they are expected to behave within a particular society (World Health Organization, 2021).

The drug phenomenon has often been approached as gender neutral, even though sex and gender play significant roles in pathways to drug use, related behaviors, risk factors, and the harms of addiction. According to (Rasha Abi Hana, 2022), an intersectional approach is rarely applied, and research often overlooks how gender interacts with other factors such as gender identity and sexuality. The Symposium on Gender and Drugs aims to explore the interplay between gender and drug use by highlighting the importance of integrating a gender perspective into drug-

related research and policy. Its objectives include promoting a deeper understanding of the drug phenomenon through a gender lens, encouraging multidisciplinary discussion, and identifying ways to incorporate gender-sensitive approaches into international drug initiatives.

Substance use disorders affect both women and men. Although prevalence rates are generally higher among men, women with addictive disorders often exhibit a more vulnerable profile. They are less likely to seek or access treatment (Fonseca et al., 2021). This study aims to provide an overview of how sex and gender influence the epidemiology, clinical manifestations, social impact, and neurobiological basis of SUDs, with a particular focus on women based on human research.

According to the National Institute on Drug Abuse NIDA (2020), a person's sex and gender significantly influence how they interact with drugs from first exposure to reasons for use and approaches to treatment. While each individual's experience with addiction is unique, consistent trends related to sex and gender have been observed. In this context, sex refers to biological factors, whereas gender pertains to sociocultural influences. Across most age groups, men generally have higher rates of drug use and dependence.

LACK OF KNOWLEDGE AND AWARENESS

According to Parmar (2018), drug abuse is mainly the result of interaction between person, abused drug, and the environment with changing patterns from time to time. Knowledge and awareness regarding this giant problem and its effects are still less, easy access to drugs at certain places, other factors contribute in substance addiction. The young generation usually involved in drug abuse because of lack of knowledge regarding its complications, peer pressure, influence by social media etc. The most prevalent used drugs were alcohol, opium, and marijuana till today. Present study was undertaken to assess knowledge and awareness of medical students regarding substance addiction because they will serve key role in future by treating and counseling patients.

Additionally, national study conducted by Pengpid et al., (2025) ,similarly found that only about 44% of Filipino adolescents had ever received education about the dangers of drug use in school. This lack of exposure to formal drug education highlights a nationwide deficiency in knowledge and awareness before attending drug prevention activities such as symposiums.

Most of the school students according to Garg et al., (2025), had poor knowledge and attitudes regarding substance use. They had limited awareness of the harms and treatment of substance abuse. Social stigma for substance abuse was evident in the majority of students. About 3.3% of students reported ever use of substances. The commonest reported substances were alcohol, tobacco, and cannabis. The knowledge and attitudes were poor in students of urban areas, private schools, students of classes 9th and 10th, and those of middle socioeconomic status. Ever use was higher in males, students from rural areas, and classes 11th and 12th.

Poor Risk Perception

Evaluated a mobile-app intervention among Mexican high-school students (mean age ≈ 15) aimed at increasing risk perception of tobacco, alcohol and marijuana. They found the intervention significantly increased the risk perception for use of tobacco and alcohol, and marginally for marijuana. Importantly, the study underscores that risk perception is not fixed it can be raised through targeted intervention involving knowledge, life-skills, resistance to peer-pressure, and self-esteem. This supports your interest in how drug-awareness seminars may shift risk perception (Fuentes A et al., 2023).

In this study by (Mariani & Williams, 2021) using data, about 80 % of adolescents perceived risk of harm from monthly cannabis use; however, important protective factors were identified: parental monitoring, perception of school importance, and peer disapproval. The findings reinforce that while risk perception may be present for some substances, it is shaped by

peer, parental and school influences. In turn, poor risk perception (or lower than optimal perception) may reflect weak protective influences or strong risk-favouring environments.

This large-school survey (N≈59,000) showed that adolescents frequently underestimated the harms associated with synthetic and "other" drugs: they saw them as accessible and problematic in their school settings, yet believed the harms to be limited. This finding illustrates directly how poor risk perception, underestimating the harm of a drug acts as a risk factor for use. It also shows the role of environmental perceptions in shaping risk appraisal (Debnam et al., 2018)

Furthermore, (Mak et al., 2019) found that adolescents in Hong Kong identified a variety of personal and social vulnerabilities—such as peer influence, family dysfunction, and limited refusal skills—that lowered their perception of the risk of alcohol, tobacco and drug use, thereby increasing their susceptibility to substance use.

High Tendency to Peer Pressure

Adolescents' high susceptibility to peer pressure is a well-documented risk factor for initiating substance use prior to any preventive programs or interventions. A meta-analysis by (Li et al., 2024), revealed that both perceived and actual peer substance use significantly predicted adolescents' own drug-use behaviors, with perceived peer norms having a stronger effect (β = 0.179) than actual peer use (β = 0.095). This indicates that adolescents often model their behaviors based on what they believe their peers are doing or approving of, even in the absence of direct influence. Such findings suggest that peer dynamics and perceived social acceptance play a pivotal role in shaping drug-related attitudes and tendencies before exposure to awareness or educational seminars.

Adolescents' association with peers who engage in substance use significantly increases their own risk of using drugs, illustrating how a high tendency to peer pressure

can exist well before any formal prevention activities such as seminars. For example, a study by Dishion and et al. found that adolescents whose friends smoked had an odds ratio (OR) = 5.446 for their own smoking compared to those whose friends did not, and those who were directly invited by a friend to smoke had an OR = 10.455. This demonstrates that peer influence and invitations from peers form strong antecedents to substance-use behaviour, underlining the importance of addressing "high tendency to peer pressure" in your baseline measurement before the intervention (Loke & Mak, 2015)

Adolescents who experience higher levels of peer pressure show a significantly greater likelihood of engaging in substance use behaviors and compromising their autonomy development even before any formal preventive intervention. Specifically, a longitudinal study by (Allen et al., 2025), found that exposure to peer pressure during early adolescence was associated not only with increased substance use but also with diminished functional independence and higher risk of coercive relationships in later adolescence and early adulthood.

Perceived Behavioral Control

According to (Evangelia Argyriou et al., 2018) Implicated in the initiation, maintenance, and relapse of drug-seeking behaviors involved in drug addiction. Research shows that changes in impulsive behavior across the lifespan contribute to drug use and addiction. The goal of this review is to examine existing research on the relationship of drug use across the lifespan and to recommend directions for future research. Three domains of impulsive behavior are explored in this review: impulsive behavior-related personality traits, delay discounting, and prepotent response inhibition. First, we present

previous research on these three domains of impulsive behavior and drug use across developmental stages. Then, we discuss how changes in impulsive behavior across the lifespan are implicated in the progression of drug use and addiction. Finally, we discuss the relatively limited attention given to middle-to-older adults in the current literature, consider the validity of the measures used to assess impulsive behavior in middle-to-older adulthood, and suggest recommendations for future research.

According to La Barbera F. , and Ajzen, I (2021), Investigators frequently rely on the theory of planned behavior (TPB) as a conceptual framework to explain and predict human behavior in a variety of behavioral domains. Much of this research has focused on predicting behavioral intentions from attitudes, subjective norms and perceived behavioral control, typically by examining the additive effects of these constructs. However, in the original formulation of the TPB, perceived behavioral control was postulated to moderate the influence of attitude and subjective norm on intention. This tenet of the TPB has been drawing increasing attention in recent years. In a preregistered program of research conducted in two European countries (Germany and UK) concerning two different behaviors (exercising and reducing energy consumption), we found empirical support for the postulated moderating effects. The results suggest that as scores on perceived behavioral control increase, the strength of the association between attitude and intention increases as well, whereas the strength of the association between subjective norm and intention decreases. Implications of these findings for theory and future research are discussed.

Behavioral Awareness of Consequences of Drug Use

Substance abuse among adolescents has become a global challenge and an important public health concern. Aims include to assess and compare the knowledge score on substance abuse and its consequences among the adolescents before and after administration of health awareness programme. Adolescence is the period of storm and stress. Health awareness programme is an effective method to gain knowledge and develop favorable attitude toward the prevention of substance abuse among adolescents Hansadah, T., & Sonalika, S. (2024).

Research on adolescent drug abuse emphasizes that risk and protective factors—such as personal attitudes, awareness, and behavioral perceptions—significantly influence the likelihood of drug involvement. Limited awareness of health and social consequences often leads young people to underestimate the severity of risks, making them more vulnerable to experimentation and continued use. Nawi et al. (2021)

According to Shyamashree (2024), among 2,170 participants, a substantial minority had “good knowledge” about substance use, but many did not. The study identified various determinants influencing knowledge and attitude: for example, social background, prior exposure, and individual characteristics. This suggests that even in higher-education settings, awareness and attitudes toward drugs vary widely depending on demographic and contextual factors.

According to Patel Y., and Mehta, H (2024), the rate of substance abuse is rapidly increasing and has become a worldwide issue. Public awareness regarding the dangers

associated with substance use is limited. Substance use, such as tobacco, cigarette, alcohol, illegal drugs and the misuse of prescription medications, has become increasingly normalized as a means of flaunting among today's youth. The increase in substance abuse increases the crime rate. Substance abuse is an unimaginable threat to humanity also. It ruins the individual's social as well as economic life. It also deteriorates the health of an individual. Most of the people are unaware of any law or government initiatives against substance abuse. The public lacks proper understanding of the severe consequences and effects of substance abuse. Considering the current situation, spreading awareness about substance abuse within the community has become essential. This study aims to assess people's awareness of the causes and effects of substance abuse and how they cope with such situations. It provides detailed information regarding substance abuse.

1.4 Schematic Diagram

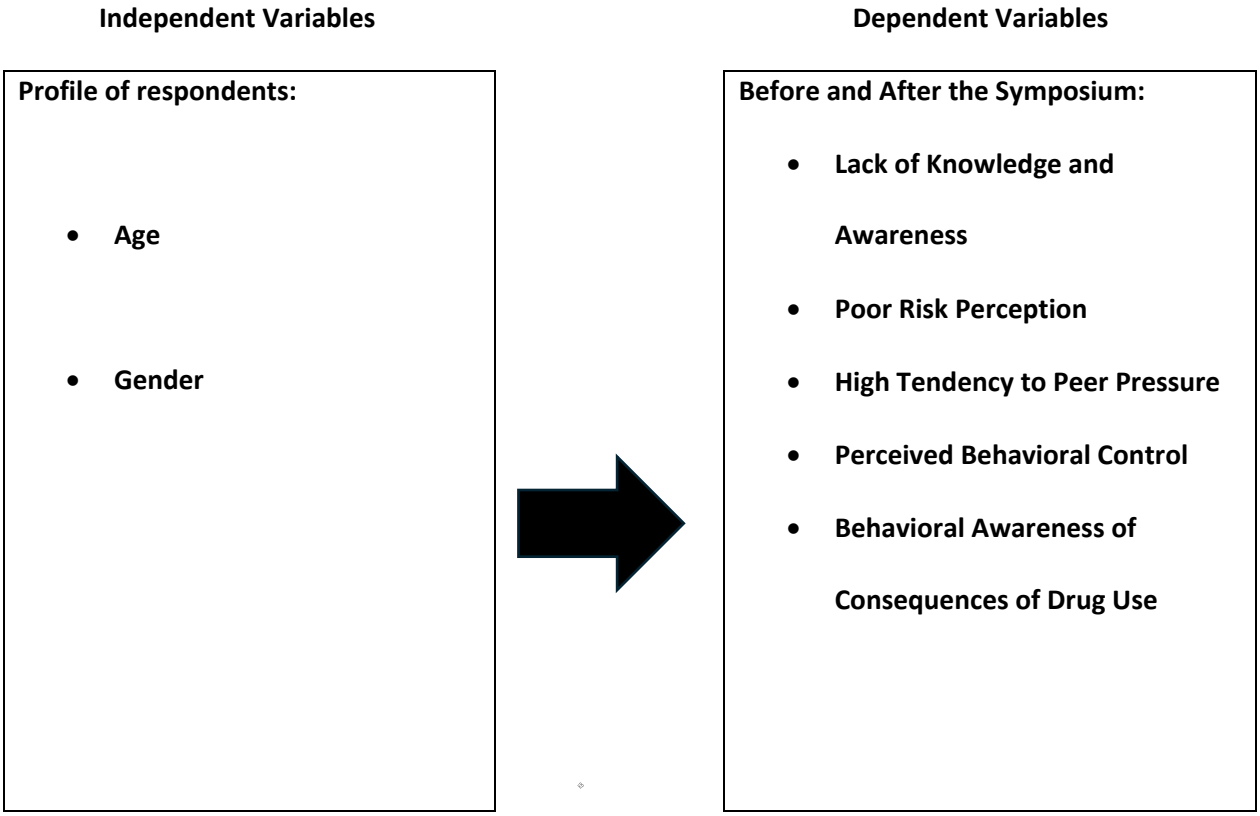


Figure no. 1 The schematic diagram shows the relationship between the independent variable and the dependent variables of the sample.

1.5 Statement of the Problem/ Objectives of the Study

Statement of the Problem This study explores the effectiveness of drug symposium seminars partnered by PNP Nasipit in enhancing awareness and promoting behavioral change among students regarding illegal drug use. Specifically, this quantitative research focuses on understanding students' perceptions and experiences related to the following objectives:

1. What is the profile of the respondents in terms of:

   1.1. Age; and

   1.2. Gender

2. What is the level of drug awareness of the respondents before the symposium?

   2.1. Lack of Knowledge and Awareness;

   2.2. Poor Risk Perception; and

   2.3. High Tendency to Peer Pressure

3. What is the level of effectiveness of drug symposium awareness and behavioral change of the respondents after the symposium?

   3.1.

4. Is there a significant difference between the level of awareness and behavioral change before and after the drug symposium seminars?

1.6 Hypothesis

There is no significant relationship between the level of effectiveness of drug symposium seminars on awareness and behavioral change before and after drug symposium and the respondent’s profile.

1.7 Scope and Limitations

This study examines how effectively the Philippine National Police (PNP) Nasipit conducted drug awareness seminars for SMCC students during the 2025–2026 school year. It wants to find out how much students learned about drugs and whether their behavior or choices about drugs changed. The research includes only students who attended the seminars, focusing on improvements in their knowledge and any changes in their attitudes or habits.

The study has some limitations. It depends on students' answers, which might be affected by memory or personal opinion. It only measures changes shortly after the seminars, so it does not show whether the changes last long. The results apply only to PNP Nasipit's program and might not be the same for other schools or programs. Other things, like family, media, or community programs, are not included but could influence students' awareness and behavior. Finally, because it only looks at students who attended the seminars, it cannot compare them to students who did not join.

1.8 Definition of Terms

The important words in this study are explained clearly so everyone can understand them. These definitions help readers know exactly what the terms mean when discussing behavior changes caused by drug use. Each word is explained using past studies and how it applies to this research.

Age. Is simply how long a person or thing has been around, calculated from the day it started until today.

Awareness. Is simply knowing what's happening right now, both inside you and outside.

Drug. Refers to a substance that changes how your body or mind works. It can be used for medicine or it can be harmful if used the wrong way.

Gender. Refers to how they feel and express themselves. It's not just about biology, but also about how people see themselves and how society views them like being a man, woman, or another gender identity.

Illegal Drugs. Refers to a substance that people are not allowed to use, make, or sell because it is harmful to the body and mind.

Knowledge. It means the information or understanding of a person, it helps to know what is right and wrong.

Peer Pressure. Refers to the influence from friends or people that pushes you to do something.

Risk Perception. Refers to how a person sees or understand the danger or harm.

CHAPTER 2

RESEARCH METHODOLOGY

2.1 Research Design

The study will be conducted in various secondary schools located within the Municipality of Nasipit, Province of Agusan del Norte, situated in the Caraga Region of Mindanao, Philippines. Nasipit is a first-class municipality known for its mix of urban and rural communities, covering 19 barangays with a total population of approximately 44,822 based on the 2020 Census by the Philippine Statistics Authority. The municipality is approximately 24 kilometers west of Butuan City and serves as one of the major economic and educational centers in the province.

The locale was selected because of the active participation of the Philippine National Police (PNP) Nasipit and various educational institutions in conducting drug symposiums and awareness seminars aimed at promoting anti-drug campaigns among the youth. The presence of both public and private secondary schools provides an ideal setting for assessing the effectiveness of drug prevention programs across diverse educational environments.

2.2 Research Materials and Methods

The study used a questionnaire developed by the researchers to assess changes in students' awareness and attitudes before and after the drug symposium seminars. This method, called a pre-test and post-test, helps show how much the seminars influenced the students. The study also describes the students' ages and genders to better understand them.

The questionnaire has two main parts: one asks about students' personal information, and the other asks about their awareness and attitudes toward drugs, using a simple scale to measure responses. The collected data will be carefully analyzed using statistical methods to ensure the results are precise and reliable. Before using the questionnaire for the study, the researcher will test it with a small group to ensure it is easy to understand.

The study will use numbers and averages to summarize students' responses, and a paired t-test will be used to determine whether there were fundamental changes in awareness and attitudes after the seminars. By using these methods, the research will show how effective the PNP Nasipit drug symposiums are in helping students learn about drugs and change their behavior for the better.

2.3 Research Environment, Population and Sample

The study will be conducted in the Municipality of Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, involving four public secondary schools. The first school will be Nasipit National Vocational School (NNVS), which will be located at Bayview Hill, Barangay 7 (Azucena), Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. The second school will be Nasipit National High School (NNHS), which will be situated in Barangay Cubi-Cubi, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte. The third school will be Calixto D. Montinola National High School (CDMNHS), which will be located in Barangay 4, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte, near the Nasipit Public Market. The fourth school will be Culit National High School (CNHS), which will be located in Barangay Culit, Nasipit, Agusan del Norte.

These schools will be selected as the research locale because they represent different barangays within the municipality and provide a diverse population of Grade 10 students relevant to the objectives of the study.

Table 1

Population and Sample Distribution by Schools

(N = 416, n = 200)

	Population			Sample					
School	Male	Female	Total	Male		Female		Total	
	F	F	F	f	%	f	%	f	%
NNVS	114	96	210	55	27.5	46	23.0	101	50.5
NNHS	18	14	32	9	4.5	7	3.5	16	8.0
CDMNHS	74	54	128	35	17.5	26	13.0	61	30.5
CNHS	19	27	46	9	4.5	13	6.5	22	11.0
Total	225	191	416	108	54.0	92	46.0	200	100.0

The study uses stratified sampling method, dividing the population into strata based on the Grade 10 students from four different schools. This ensures that each schools is proportionally represented, enhancing the results, reliability of the results.

2.4 Research Data and Analysis Plan

This study will use quantitative research to find out how practical the PNP Nasipit drug symposium seminars are in teaching students about drugs and helping them change their behavior. To do this, students will answer a survey questionnaire before and after attending the seminars. The questions will measure what students know about drugs and how they feel about using them.

To better understand the students, the study will examine their age and gender. The results will be shown using frequencies and percentages, making it easy to see the group's makeup.

The study will also use the weighted mean to check how much students', understand the Lack of Knowledge and Awareness, Poor Risk Perception, High Tendency to Peer Pressure, Intention to Refuse Drugs, Improved Risk Perception and Increased Knowledge and Awareness, before and after the seminars. Finally, paired T-tests will be used to determine whether the changes in awareness and behavior are significant, indicating that the seminars really made a difference.

2.5 Research Ethical Standards

A. **Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)**

This study did not create any new technology or product that needs a patent. All materials, including the survey questions and analysis tools, are original and protected by Philippine copyright law. Any ideas or tools taken from other sources are correctly cited. Since the study did not make a new logo, symbol, or brand, there is no need for a trademark.

B. **Informed Consent**

Before joining the study, students from Nasipit were informed about its purpose, what it would do, and how it might help. They were assured that taking part was their choice and that their answers would have no effect on their school grades. Each student gave written consent to participate. Since the study did not involve animals or other living creatures, no extra approval for animal safety was needed.

C. **Data Privacy and Confidentiality**

The study follows the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173). This means that any personal information from students is collected only with their consent. Their answers are kept private, and

their names are not shown. The information may be shared for school or research purposes only if the students agree.

D. **Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw**

Joining the study is entirely up to each student. They can say no or stop without any punishment or problem. No one is forced, pressured, or rewarded to take part.

E. **Minimization of Harm**

The study is very safe because students only answer questions on a survey. Their answers will not affect their grades or how others see them. If any question makes them uncomfortable, they can skip it or stop at any time. No animals are involved in this study.

F. **Beneficence**

This study hopes to help the community by checking how well the PNP-Nasipit drug seminars teach students about the dangers of drugs and help them make better choices. The results help improve future anti-drug programs. A summary of what was learned will be shared with the schools and the PNP to help them improve their programs.

G. **Justice and Fair Respondent Selection**

Students are selected fairly from different schools in Nasipit that participated in the PNP drug seminars. Everyone has an equal chance of being included, and no one is left out or picked too often.

H. **Data Integrity and Accuracy**

We use precise, careful methods to collect and analyze information, ensuring results are accurate and trustworthy. All answers are recorded honestly, and we also explain any problems or mistakes that might happen.

I. **Transparency in Reporting**

The researcher will present the study's results honestly and clearly. We will give credit to all sources and materials we use and will not change or make up any information.

J. **Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials**

The study does not use any new inventions or special software. It only uses school materials and surveys from other people, and we make sure to give them credit.

K. **Ethical Considerations for Human and Animal Trials**

This study only involves students as participants. Everyone taking part is told what the study is about, their rights, and that it is safe. No animals are used in this research, so no special approvals for animal testing are needed.

L. **Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies**

AI tools like ChatGPT are used carefully to help organise ideas and improve grammar. The researchers check and edit everything the AI produces to ensure it is correct and trustworthy.

M. **Ethical Approval**

This study will get approval from the Institutional Review Board (IRB) of Saint Michael College of Caraga to ensure all research is conducted ethically and safely.